



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 12: Breaking the Ice: Impress to Express

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First Impression: Why is it important?

"You never get a second chance to make a first impression."

AND

"A good first impression can work wonders."

- J. K. Rowling

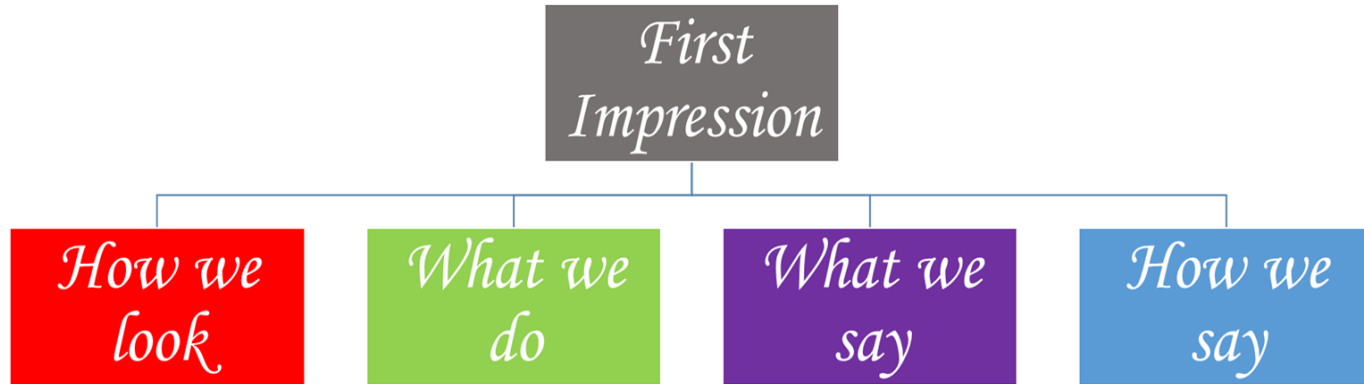


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First Impression in Public Speaking

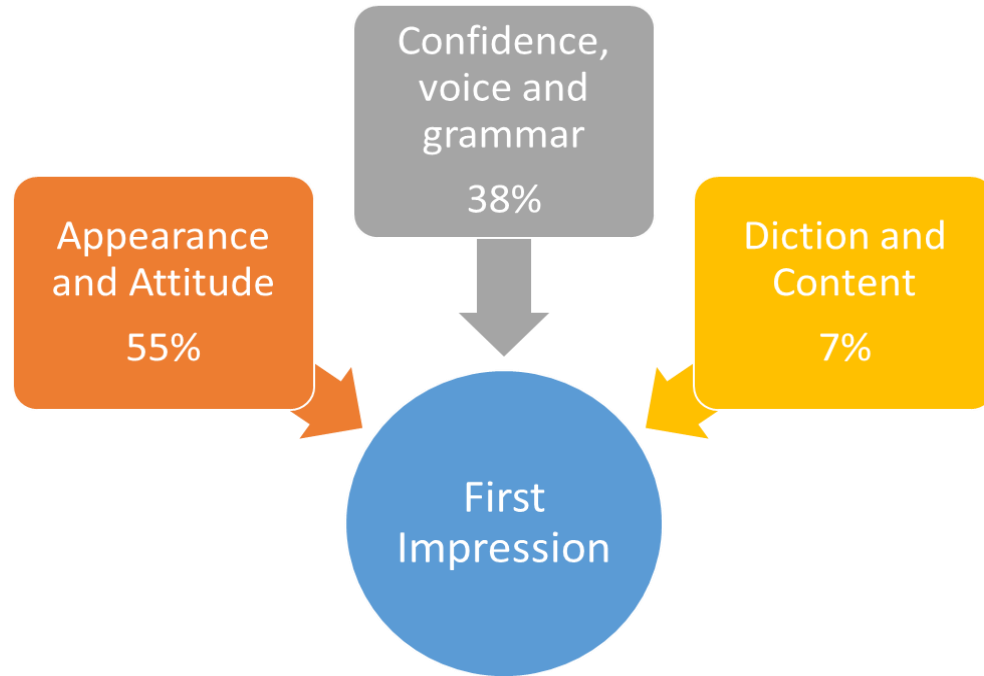
- ❑ First Impression plays a crucial role in the personal, social and professional development of an individual.
- ❑ Chinese thinker, Sun Tzu says: “**Every battle is won or lost before it is ever fought**”. The skill of casting a good first impression offers an advantageous position to a speaker - the attention and credibility of the audience is mostly won over much before the speech has begun.
- ❑ As public speaking is a special skill in the contemporary world, and making a good first impression happens to be a vital component of it, therefore it can be established that the duo are the building blocks of the road to success - personally and professionally.
- ❑ **Fact check:** In a survey of 2,000 hiring managers, 33% claimed to know whether or not they would be hiring a candidate in less than 30 seconds! **First Impression Matters!!!**

Factors Influencing First Impression



- ❑ **How We Look:** Align your appearance with the image you want to portray and the message you want to deliver. Right from personal appearance - clothing, hair, shoes - to the slides, flyers, brochures and handouts, all of it ought to appear engaging and fascinating to the audience.
- ❑ **What We Do:** Make choices in real life consistent with what you speak in public. Lead by examples and actions.
- ❑ **What We Say:** Verbals and non-verbals both hold equal significance in creating a strong first impression. Make lucid, smart and professional statements. Curate your speech carefully focused on the audience and the occasion. Communicate using a jargon-less, intelligible and appropriate diction.
- ❑ **How We Say:** Speak with confidence in your tone. Wear a smile on your face. Refine your pronunciation. Keep your conversational pace suited to the comprehensive ability of your audience.

First Impression: Building Blocks



First Impression with the Audience: Tips for Pre-Performance

- ❑ **Groom Up:** Choose a comfortable and decent outfit suited to the occasion and keep a tidy appearance.
- ❑ **Create a Comfortable Ambience:** Check for a pleasant and comfortable setup of the venue -
 - ❑ Lighting
 - ❑ Microphone
 - ❑ Seating arrangement
 - ❑ Background music
 - ❑ Technological aids

- ❑ **Plan your Speech:** Research about your audience. Plan your speech beforehand; highlight the key messages; define your objectives, prepare a strong beginning and a memorable ending.
- ❑ **Practise Communication Skills** - Work on your vocabulary and articulation. Practise your speech in front of a mirror or your friends and work on the feedback. Keep it natural.
- ❑ **Scheme a Strategic Pre-Event Promotion:** Market your speech and your ideas ahead of the event through social media tools like Facebook, Twitter hashtags and online campaigning.
- ❑ **Arrange for takeaways:** Target to achieve a lingering effect on your audience by providing them with catchy takeaways - summary brochures, CDs/DVDs pertaining to the message of your speech.

First Impressions: Common Slips

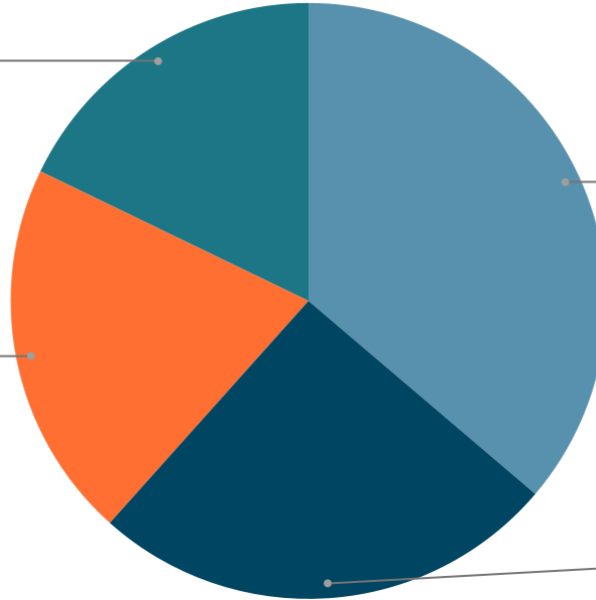
Points scored

Bad Posture
17.8%

Expressionless Face
20.5%

Fail to make Eye
36.2%

Poor Knowledge
25.4%



CARNEGIE'S 6 RULES

1. BE GENUINELY INTERESTED



2. SMILE



3. USE THEIR NAME



4. LISTEN



5. TALK IN TERMS OF THEIR INTEREST



6. MAKE THEM FEEL IMPORTANT



First Impression with the Audience: Tips for Delivery Day

☐ **Be on Time:**

- ☐ Plan to arrive a few minutes early.
- ☐ Allow room for delays in traffic.
- ☐ Check the ambience and tech connections beforehand.

☐ **Positive and Confident Body Language:**

- ☐ Check your Posture
- ☐ Relax your facial muscles
- ☐ Wear a smile
- ☐ Make eye contact

❑ Give a Strong and Riveting Opening:

“Blackshirts of revolution, men and women of all Italy, Italians all over the world, beyond the mountains, beyond the seas, listen. A solemn hour is about to strike in the history of the country. Twenty million Italians are at this moment gathered in the squares of Italy. It is the greatest demonstration that human history records. Twenty millions, one heart alone, one will, one decision.”
(Mussolini)

- ❑ Prepare the 60-90 seconds talk to hook your audience and relax yourself into speech.
- ❑ Don't start with self-introduction.
- ❑ Introduce your topic through an engaging talk.
- ❑ Direct questions can be catchy openers - *“How many times have you...? Or, “Raise your hand if...”*.
- ❑ Openings can also be humorous in a tell-tale manner - *“I’ll never forget the day when...”*.
- ❑ A bold or shocking statement also works its part to give audience a reason to put down their mobile phones and pull out their notepads.

- ❑ **Demonstrate Cultural Sensitivity:**
Communicate ideas in a language sensitive to gender and culture.
- ❑ **Be Polite and Courteous:** Put forward your arguments with decorum.
- ❑ **Encourage Audience Participation :**
Make your speech more inclusive by a two-way exchange.
- ❑ **Respond to Questions Gracefully**
- ❑ **Tailor your Tone:** Use your voice to your best advantage.
- ❑ **Be Authentic:** Project the best version of yourself, but the genuine one!

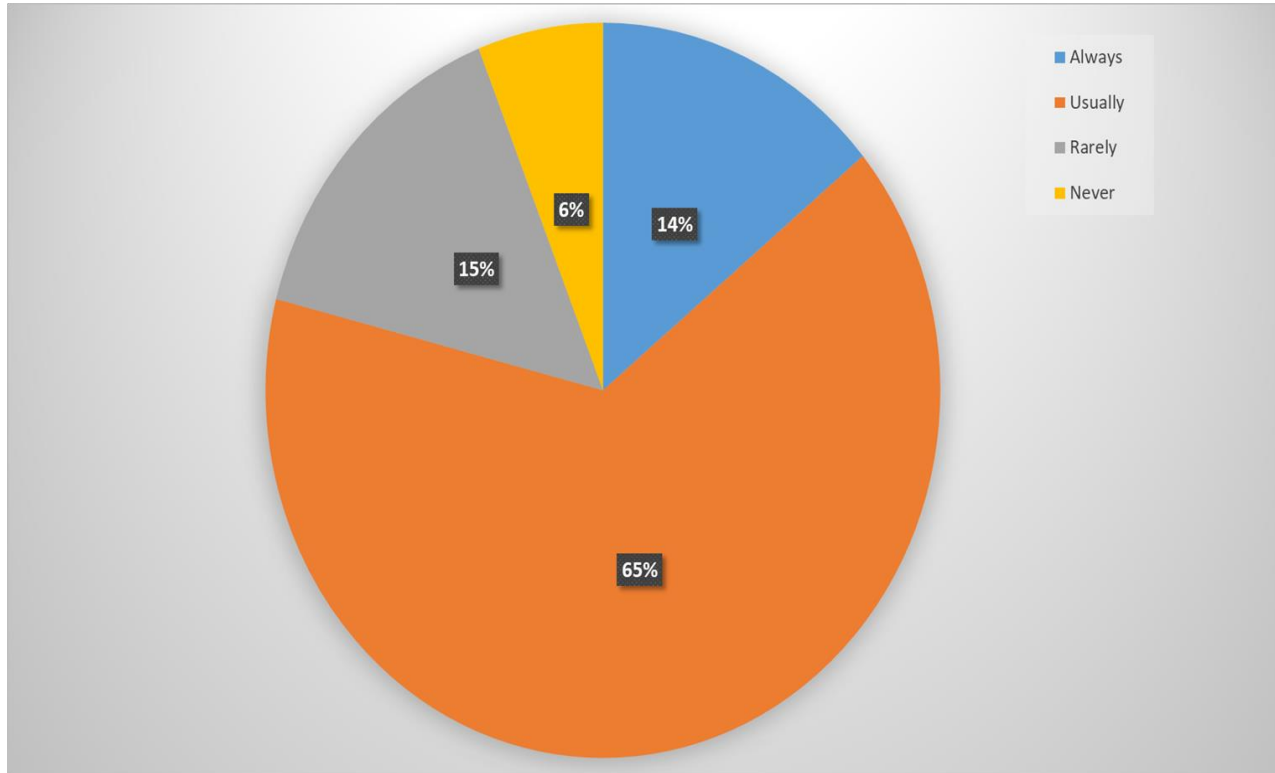


Being Heard and Cheered by your Audience

- Greet your audience cheerfully.
- Establish a cordial rapport.
- Address the audience on a personal level.
- Channel your talk so as to make your listeners feel important.

Having Audience Sleep through your Presentation

- Keep your audience waiting.
- Mumble or speak falteringly..
- Encumber your speech with '*ums*' and '*ahs*'.
- Read out to your audience in a monotonous voice.



As per survey reports, the above pie chart shows the percentage of people who believe they make a good first impression.

Things to remember

- Avoid opening your talk with a humorous story.
- Begin your talk on a cordial note.
- Audience are interested in your talk and not apologies.
- Create curiosity.
- Open your talk with story/question/anecdote/quote.
- Avoid opening your talk too formally.
- Audience hear what they expect to hear.

“Tell them what you’re going to tell them, then tell them, then tell them that you’ve told them.”

- Hillaire Belloc

First Impression Lasts!



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Thank You!

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